

Açelya Altun

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Repression, political violence, state terror, historical legacies, contentious politics, quantitative methods, machine learning, geospatial methods, Middle East politics.

EDUCATION

University of Washington, Seattle, WA 2025 – Present
PhD in Political Science
Fields: Comparative Politics, Political Economy, Methodology

Sabancı University, Istanbul, Turkey 2023 – 2025
MA in Political Science
Advisor: Assist. Prof. Serkant Adıgüzel

Bogazici University, Istanbul, Turkey 2017 – 2023
BA in Political Science and International Relations
Certificate in Film Studies

WORKING PAPERS

Tracing Autocrats: Rethinking Repertoire of Repression and Measurement
- Ione E. Curtis Graduate Research Grant (2026-2027)

Fig Gardens in Syria: Legacies of Repression on Dissent and Insurgency

DATA PROJECTS

TRACE – Turkey Repression and Contentious Events Dataset (2013-2025)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, University of Washington
Pol S 204: Introduction to Comparative Politics - Prof. Asli Cansunar Autumn 2025
Pol S 331: Middle East and North Africa - Prof. Asli Cansunar Winter 2026

Teaching Assistant, Sabancı University
SPS 102: Humanity and Society II 2023 – 2025

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, University of Washington Summer 2026
Assisted Prof. Gabriella Levy's research project on developing measures of transitional justice.

Research Assistant, Sabancı University Summer 2024
Conducted a literature review on late Ottoman and early Republican media as part of a research project carried out by Prof. Serkant Adıgüzel.

Research Assistant, Bogazici University Summer 2022
Carried out archival research from newspapers for Prof. Mert Arslanalp and Prof. Deniz Erkmen's research project on protests and mobile emergency bans in Turkey.

AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

Ione E. Curtis Graduate Research Grant, University of Washington (\$1500)	2026-2027
Graduate School Fellowship, University of Washington	Spring 2026
Graduate School Fellowship, Sabancı University	2023 – 2025
Undergraduate Fellowship, Bogazici University Foundation	2017 – 2022

SKILLS

Languages: Turkish (native), English (advanced), Persian (beginner), Arabic (beginner)

Software: R, L^AT_EX, Stata, Python (beginner)

REFERENCES

Assoc. Prof. Asli Cansunar

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Prof. Mine Eder

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Assist. Prof. Mert Arslanalp

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